MONTHLY UPDATE

Southern Africa: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

PROGRESS

INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES
Regional collaboration

INSTRUMENTS AND HARMONISATION
AI

SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE
Data Exchange · Digital Payments and Fintech

COORDINATION AND COLLABORATION
Innovation ecosystem

CAPACITY AND INCLUSION
Training and skills · Digital divides

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

REGIONAL HIGHER EDUCATION DATA SYSTEM

- **SADC must build its own knowledge to drive industrialisation, says Manamela** — SAnews (South African Government News Agency), 1 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Manamela sets five priorities for SADC universities, among them a regional higher education data system.

- **Universities should turn regional cooperation into action** — University of the Witwatersrand, 1 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  SADC vice-chancellors meet at Wits, 31 Aug to 1 Sep 2026, on a regional higher education data system.

CRASA (COMMUNICATIONS REGULATORS ASSOCIATION OF SOUTHERN AFRICA)

- **CRASA Committee for the 2026/27 Financial Year Meets in Gaborone, 2-4 September** — Communications Regulators' Association of Southern Africa (CRASA), 2 September 2026

  First ordinary in-person meeting of the financial year, convened to advance the CSPC Workplan 2026/27.

- **46th Ordinary Meeting of the CRASA Executive Committee (EXCO)** — CRASA, 16 September 2026 MALAWI

  CRASA's own listing dates the 46th ExCo 14-16 September 2026 at Makokola Club, Mangochi; rescheduled on venue.

PROMOTION OF REGIONAL CAPITAL-MARKET INTEGRATION

- **SADC positions Southern Africa as an Integrated Investment destination at AIM Congress 2026** — Southern African Development Community (SADC), 9 September 2026

  SADC and CoSSE at AIM Congress Dubai, 7-9 September 2026, promoting regional capital-market integration.

SADCOPAC RESOLUTIONS ON OVERSIGHT OF DIGITAL SYSTEMS

- **SADC PACs sub committees examine 3 dimensions of future public accountability** — Eswatini Positive News, 15 September 2026 ESWATINI

  SADCOPAC: executives see spending in real time, PACs 12-24 months later; AI screening urged for audit.

- **SADCOPAC turns oversight into action with 32 resolutions** — Eswatini Positive News, 16 September 2026

  Public accounts committees across SADC adopted 32 resolutions in Eswatini on 16 September 2026, committing each to map major digital transformation projects and review at least one digital system for value for money within 12 months. Oversight is to extend to e-government, digital identity, e-procurement and e-payment systems.

IDEA PROGRAMME (INCLUSIVE DIGITALIZATION IN EASTERN AND SOUTHERN AFRICA)

- **IDEA Half-Year Implementation Progress Report: January-June 2026 and Outlook for July-December 2026** — COMESA Secretariat (IDEA project), 1 October 2026 ANGOLA DRC MALAWI ZAMBIA ESWATINI EAST AFRICA

  COMESA spent 9% of USD 3.71m 2026 budget by June; Angola, DRC, Malawi, Zambia, Eswatini project status.

Instruments and harmonisation

AI

COMESA REGIONAL AI STRATEGY

- **AI can drive economic growth across COMESA region - COMESA director** — Eswatini Positive News, 16 September 2026 EAST AFRICA

  A COMESA official told the regional AI validation meeting in Eswatini that AI could improve public services, agriculture, health and education across the region if member states invest in the skills, infrastructure and data it needs.

- **Eswatini hosts regional push for practical AI policies** — Times of Eswatini, 16 September 2026 ESWATINI AFRICA

  Eswatini is hosting a three-day COMESA meeting, opened on 16 September 2026, to validate a draft study on AI and emerging technologies. It precedes work on a regional AI strategy, model policy guidelines and a model regulatory framework under the World Bank-funded IDEA programme.

Shared systems and infrastructure

Data Exchange

CUSTOMS-TO-CUSTOMS DATA EXCHANGE ROADMAP

- **Five Southern African countries move to link customs data as trade corridors face pressure to cut delays** — Southern African Times, 2 September 2026 ZAMBIA MALAWI MOZAMBIQUE SOUTH AFRICA ZIMBABWE

> Pretoria roadmap for customs-to-customs data exchange across five corridors, 24-26 August.

> REGIONAL CUSTOMS-TO-CUSTOMS DATA EXCHANGE ROADMAP
>
> - **Five Southern African countries move to link customs data as trade corridors face pressure to cut delays** — Southern African Times, 2 September 2026 ZAMBIA MALAWI MOZAMBIQUE SOUTH AFRICA ZIMBABWE
>
>   Summarised under Data Exchange.

> COMESA YELLOW CARD DIGITAL SALE AND VERIFICATION
>
> - **Digital overhaul targets fraud in Sh3.5bn cross-border motor insurance market** — Business Daily (Nation Media Group), 13 October 2026 ZAMBIA EAST AFRICA
>
>   Online sales piloted in Zambia; phone verification in 8 countries; 340,000 cards and US$27m premiums in 2025.

Digital Payments and Fintech

> SETTLEMENT CURRENCIES IN THE SADC-RTGS
>
> - **Metical poderá ser usado em pagamentos na SADC a partir de Janeiro de 2027** — Times de Todos, 7 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE
>
>   Mozambique's central bank governor said the metical could be used for payments between Southern African countries from January 2027 through the regional real-time settlement system, which is hosted at South Africa's central bank.

Coordination and collaboration

Innovation ecosystem

> INJINI SOUTHERN AFRICA AI EDTECH PROGRAMME
>
> - **Injini lance un programme pour soutenir 12 start-up en Afrique australe** — wearetech.africa, 9 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
>
>   The South African edtech accelerator Injini has launched an eight-month programme for twelve teams across Southern Africa building affordable AI tools adapted to local classrooms. The five strongest projects will receive seed funding at the end of it to develop their tools and test their impact with pupils and teachers; no amount is stated.

Capacity and inclusion

Training and skills

> CRASA AND LINK CENTRE MEMORANDUM ON REGULATORY CAPACITY
>
> - **CRASA and LINK Centre sign MoU** — LINK Centre - University of the Witwatersrand, 17 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
>
>   The Southern African communications regulators' association and a university research centre signed a memorandum on regulatory capacity building, applied research and policy development, covering professional development programmes, short courses, masterclasses, policy dialogues and research across the ICT, postal, audio-visual, digital media and digitally enabled sectors. Activities are expressly subject to institutional processes, funding and separate project agreements.

Digital divides

> COMESA REGIONAL DIGITAL INCLUSION STRATEGY

> - **IDEA Half-Year Implementation Progress Report: January-June 2026 and Outlook for July-December 2026** — COMESA Secretariat (IDEA project), 1 October 2026 ANGOLA DRC MALAWI ZAMBIA ESWATINI EAST AFRICA
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>   Summarised under Regional collaboration.

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